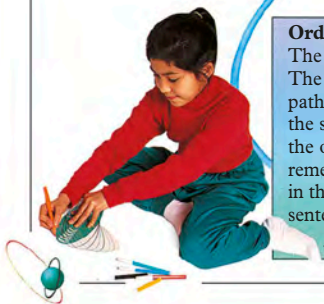


# THE OUTER PLANETS

Uranus and Neptune are the farthest planets from the sun so they are called the outer planets. They are very cold. Uranus was the first planet to be discovered using a telescope because you cannot see it from Earth just with your eyes. Pluto orbits outside Neptune and used to be classed as the ninth planet of the solar system until 2006, when it was reclassified as a dwarf planet. There are many other dwarf planets in the solar system, including Cereia, Eris, Haumea, and Makemake.

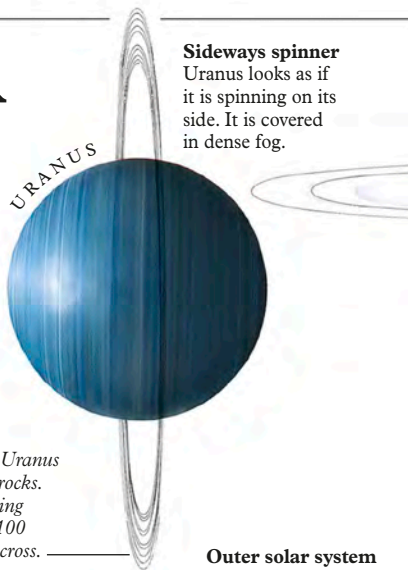
## Ellipses

The planets move around the sun in squashed circles called ellipses. This girl is drawing ellipses.



## Order of orbits

The word planet means wanderer. The planets travel around the sun in paths, called orbits. The ones nearer the sun have shorter orbits than the ones farther away. One way of remembering the order of the planets in the solar system is to remember the sentence "My Very Educated Mother Just Served Us Noodles."



**Sideways spinner**  
Uranus looks as if it is spinning on its side. It is covered in dense fog.

*The rings of Uranus are made of rocks. The widest ring is 62 miles (100 kilometers) across.*

**Outer solar system**

*This diagram shows the orbits of the planets and their places in the solar system. It does not show their sizes.*